

READ ALOUD

Drip. Drop. Glimmer. (Wiggle two fingers like snail tentacles.) *Big Wonderer and Little Wonderer visit the garden after rain. Beside a leaf, a round shell seems to move.*

A garden snail peeks out. Two long tentacles stretch into the air. On many land snails, tiny eyes sit at their tips. Shorter tentacles help sense what is nearby.

ASK **Can you point to the snail's longest tentacles?**

Under the shell, a wide, muscular foot makes gentle ripples. The snail glides forward on a thin layer of slippery mucus. **Slowly, smoothly, softly.** (Slide one hand across the other.)

ASK **What shiny trail can you spot behind the snail?**

The shell is part of the snail's body. It grows as the snail grows and helps protect the soft body. When the garden feels dry or dangerous, the snail can pull inside.

ASK **How slowly can your finger glide like a snail?**

Big Wonderer and Little Wonderer watch without touching. The snail reaches a tender leaf, and its tentacles gently wave. One small traveler has crossed a very big garden path.

Inside: a snail story · slow-motion science · first-then-last · spot the difference · a maze · counting to 20 · shapes and colors · rhymes and letter sounds · tracing and snipping · a coloring page · and a fold-up picture book.

A snail takes a garden walk



Rain dampens the garden

After rain, the ground is cool and damp. A garden snail rests beside a broad leaf, carrying its round shell on its back.

ASK **Point to the round shell beside the leaf.**



Tentacles peek out

The snail slowly stretches out its head. Two long tentacles explore the air, and two shorter tentacles sense the path nearby.

ASK **Follow one long tentacle with your finger. Can you find a shorter one?**



A broad foot ripples

A snail moves on one wide, muscular foot. Tiny waves travel along the foot, helping the snail glide slowly forward.

ASK **Can your finger glide slowly along the snail's path?**

TRY IT WITH A GROWN-UP First, look for a snail or shiny trail outdoors with your grown-up. Then, watch quietly without touching or putting anything in your mouth.

How does a snail travel?

A land snail has a soft body built for slow, smooth travel. Its foot, mucus, tentacles and shell all help along the way.



A strong foot ripples

The flat underside of a snail is one muscular foot. Gentle waves move along it and push the snail forward.



A slippery path

The snail makes a thin layer of mucus beneath its foot. This slippery layer helps it glide over rough ground and leaves a shiny trail.



Tentacles explore

Long tentacles help many land snails look around. Shorter ones sense nearby surfaces as the snail chooses its path.



The shell travels, too

A snail's shell is part of its body and grows with it. The snail can pull its soft body inside for protection and to help hold in moisture.

ASK **Point to the opening where the snail can tuck inside.**

(Every snail carries its shell wherever it glides.)

Cool and damp. *Land snails lose moisture easily. Many become active when the garden is damp, the air is humid, or the bright sun has gone down.*

EXPERIMENT WITH A GROWN-UP First, visit a damp garden path with your grown-up and look for a shiny snail trail. Then, follow its direction with your eyes only. Leave the trail just as you found it.

Which shell belongs with which snail?

Three snails have different shell patterns: stripes, spots and one plain spiral. Each has a matching shell close-up.

1 Use your finger to join each snail to the shell picture with the same pattern.



a striped snail



a spotted snail



a plain spiral snail



spotted shell



plain spiral shell



striped shell

WHY? These pictures match by shell pattern. A real snail's shell is part of its living body, not a separate house.

2 Shapes and colors in the garden

Point to each shape, then say its color with your grown-up.



brown circle

The round shell spiral looks like a circle.



green triangle

A pointed leaf tip looks like a triangle.



grey square

A flat path stone is a square.



yellow oval

A smooth flower petal looks like an oval.

ASK Can you find something round in your room?

What happened first?

Grown-up: point to each picture and tell it in a few words. Tell the story together using First, Then, and Last. Little explorer circles 1, 2 or 3 under each picture.

1 The snail begins to move



1 2 3



1 2 3



1 2 3

First, the snail rests. Then, it peeks. Last, it glides.

2 Across the garden path



1 2 3



1 2 3



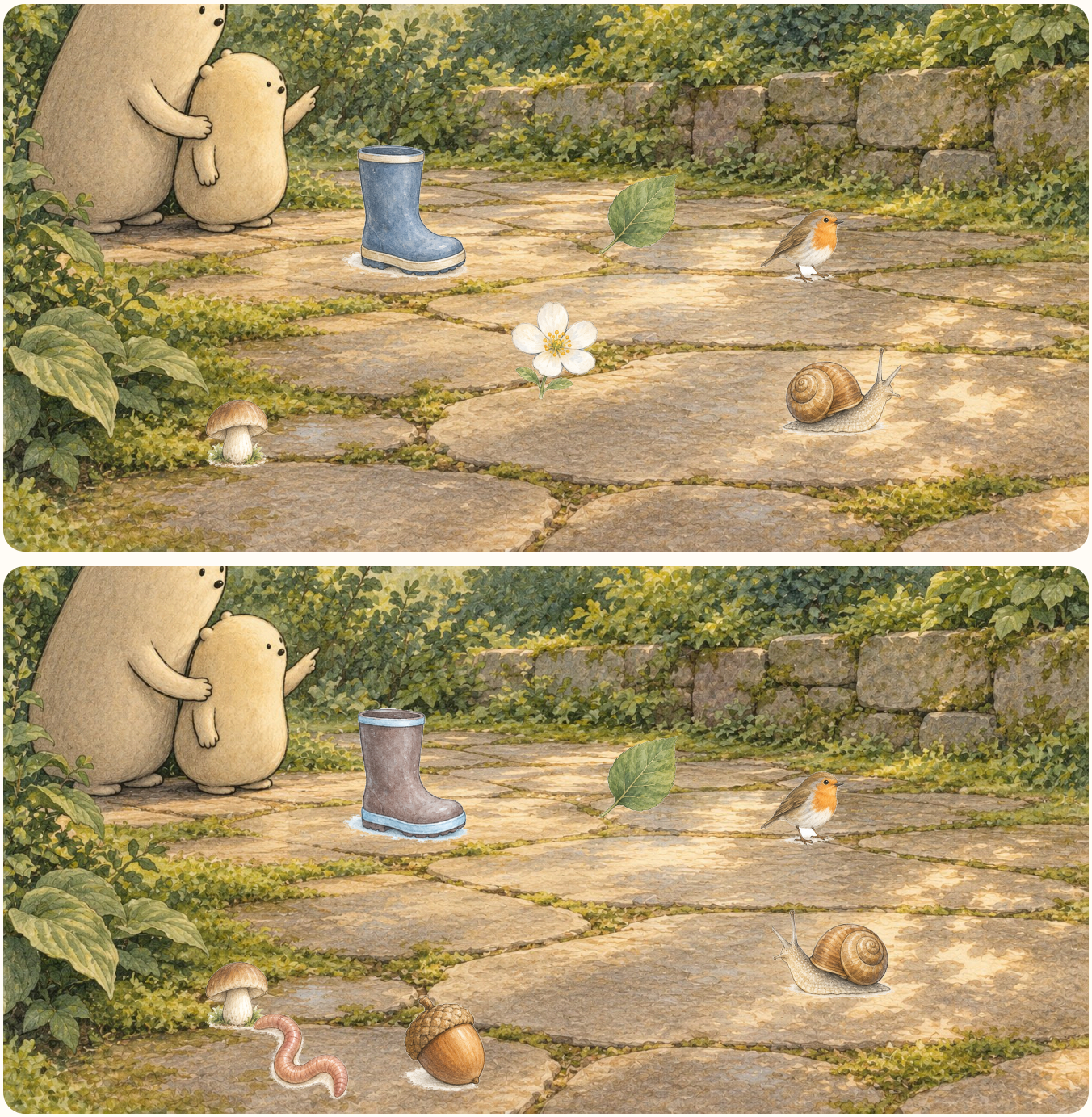
1 2 3

First, the snail glides. Then, a trail shines. Last, it reaches a leaf.

TALK ABOUT IT Where might the snail glide after its leafy stop?

Spot 5 differences

The two pictures look the same, but 5 things changed. Point to each one, then circle it in the bottom picture. Color a dot for each one you find.

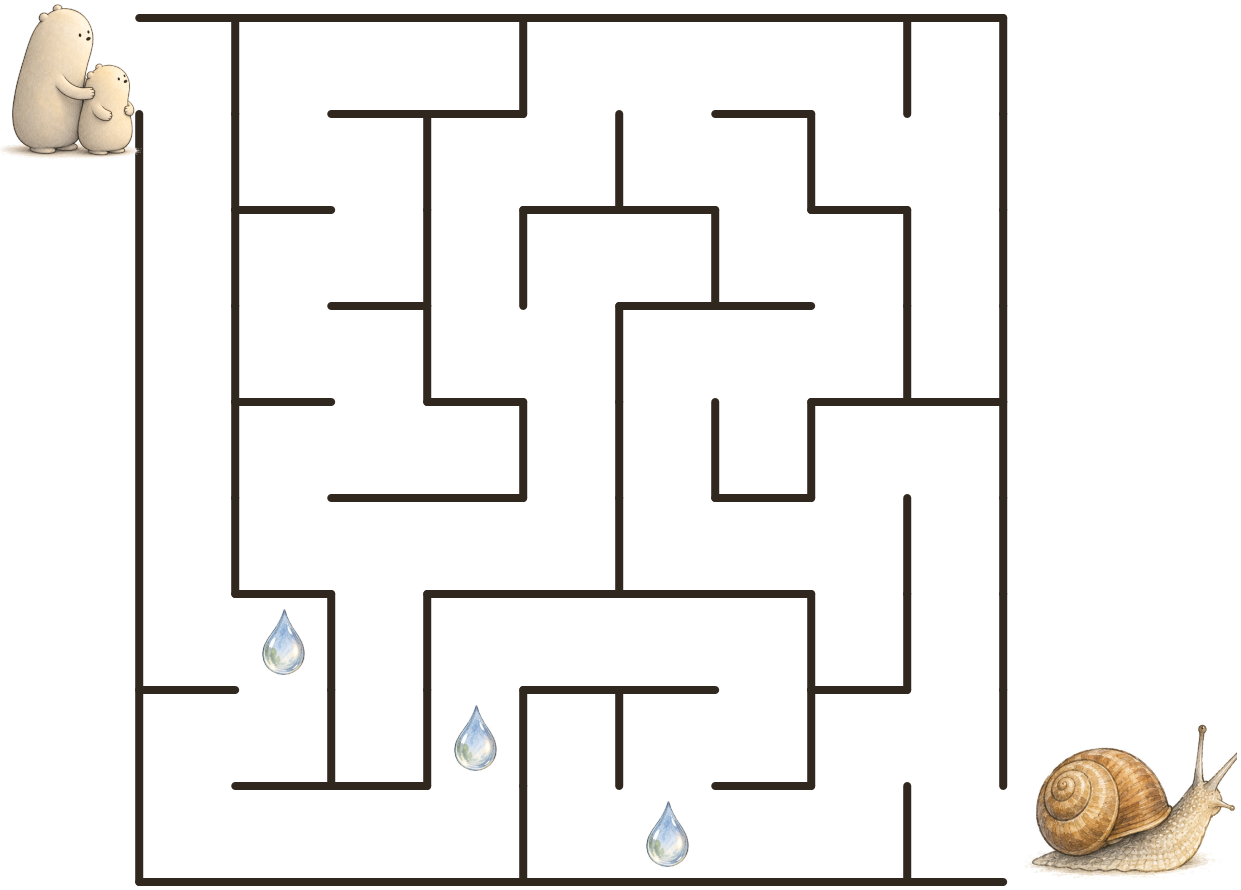


I found: ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Follow the shiny trail

Big and Little Wonderer are walking toward a garden snail. Help them find the way and spot the three dew-drop pictures along the path.

First, trace the way with a finger.
Then, touch each dew drop as you pass it.
Last, follow the way again with your finger.



Dew drops spotted:

WHY DOES A SNAIL TRAIL SHINE? A snail glides on a thin layer of mucus. When light bounces from the dried trail, the path can look silvery or shiny.

Slow garden count

1 Count the snails. Circle how many.

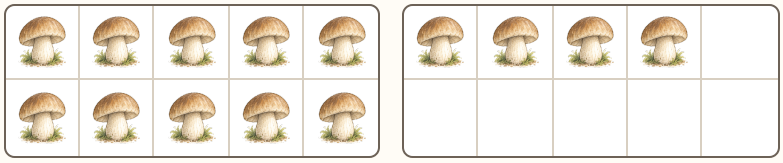


Touch each snail picture once as you count. Put a crayon dot on each picture you touch.

8 9 10 12

2 Count the mushrooms. Circle the number.

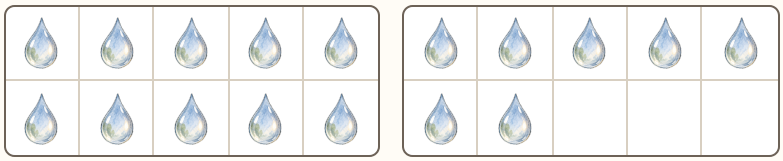
One full frame is 10. Then count on: 11, 12…



13 14 16

3 Count the dew drops. Circle the number.

10 and some more.



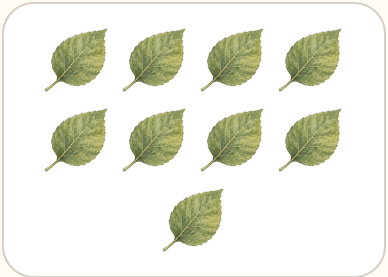
15 17 20

4 Find the number 12. Circle it.

7 12 15 20 10

5 Point to the group with MORE.





Snail picture stories

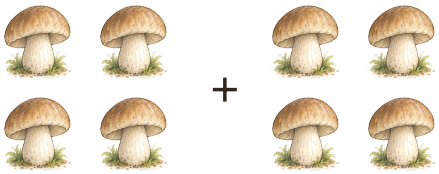
A stretch, just for fun. Grown-up reads each little story. Count the first group, then count on with the second group. Little explorer circles the answer.

3 snail pictures glide near the path. 2 more snail pictures join them. How many snails?



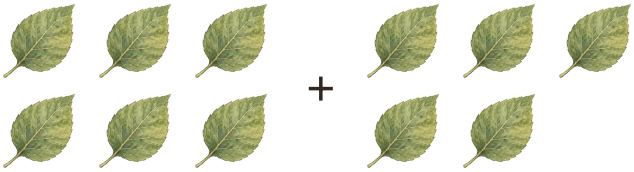
3 + 2 = (4) (5) (6)

4 mushrooms grow beside one log. 4 mushrooms grow beside another. How many mushrooms?



4 + 4 = (7) (8) (9)

6 lettuce-leaf pictures rest in the garden. Then 5 more join them. How many leaves?



6 + 5 = (10) (11) (13)

10 snail pictures fill the frame. 5 more snail pictures join them. How many snails?



10 + 5 = (14) (15) (16)

Sounds along the snail trail

S s This is the letter S, s. It says /s/, like the start of snail. Point to each S, s together.

1 **Which pictures start with /s/, like *snail*? Circle them.**


sun


snail


bug


leaf


bee


tree

2 **Rhyme time! Grown-up says the three words. Point to the two that rhyme.**


cat


hat


sun


bug


mug


tree


bee


tree


rock

3 **Read it together. Point to each word as you say it.**


A bug sits on a log.



A cat sits on a log.


4 **Just for fun: touch each letter, then say the word fast.**


s u n


b u g

Trace and snip

Count the pictures together. Trace the first number with a finger, then trace the dotted numbers with a crayon. Start at the dot.



1 1 1 1



2 2 2 2



3 3 3 3



4 4 4 4



5 5 5 5

Snip along the snail trail

With a grown-up helping, snip along the wavy line from the snail to the lettuce leaf. Safety scissors, and a grown-up holds the paper.





Color the garden snail

First, color the big round shell brown.
Then, color the flowers any colors you like.
Last, circle the snail with the longest tentacles.

Try to stay inside the lines. Big and Little Wonderer can be any color you like.



Snails

FOR LITTLE EXPLORERS

How does a snail move?

Rain wakes a quiet garden snail.

Long tentacles peek into the damp air.

A broad foot begins to ripple.

Gentle waves push the snail forward.

Slippery mucus makes a smooth path.

Tentacles help it look and sense.

The snail reaches a tender green leaf.

How to fold the picture book

1. Print the picture sheet on one page, landscape, at 100% (no scaling).
2. Fold it in half the long way, then open it. Fold it in half the short way, then in half again; open it flat.
3. **Grown-up only:** fold it in half the short way and cut along the middle fold from the folded edge to the center crease.
4. Open it, fold it the long way again, and push the ends together so the slit opens into a little book. Page 1 goes on the front.

Read it together: one picture, a few words on each page. Ask "what do you see?" before you turn the page.